Your Design Studio

Make pictures, put thoughts into words and bring them together on a page.

Your Design Studio (YDS) is a place for artwork, creative writing, event notices, lessons and guides. You might make a poster, write a family memory, illustrate a poem or arrange photographs into a small album. Keep it for yourself or choose the appropriate route to share it.

Pictures and pages

Add photographs and illustrations saved on your device, including images created elsewhere. There is no fixed limit on the number of illustrations. Resize and position them, use Fit or Fill within their boxes, and add captions.

Draw and paint with the freehand tools, shapes and colour palette. Combine your drawings with text and photographs. Move items in front of or behind others, duplicate them, and use Undo and Redo while working.

Choose portrait or landscape and add or duplicate pages. An album can have photographs, recollections and captions on successive pages. The layout is yours to arrange.

Your Writer's cap

Try a short story, poem, anecdote, personal recollection, travel account or piece about an interest you would like to share. You have freedom to choose your subject and approach. Write under your own name or the pseudonym entered in Your Information.

Type or paste your writing into text boxes, then arrange titles, paragraphs and illustrations. Highlight words to change their font, size, colour or emphasis; adjust the alignment to suit the page. Use additional pages for longer pieces.

You might pair a member's poem with their artwork, record a Club outing in words and photographs, or begin a collection of memories. YDS supplies the page-making tools; the ideas are yours.

Save and share your work

Saving keeps your work private. Publishing makes it available to others.

Keep an editable copy

Name your work. In your signed-in studio, My Vault saves the current work and opens your private Vault. Continue Working reopens an unfinished piece. Save before leaving the canvas; do not assume every change has been saved automatically.

Tools & Guide offers Save editable copy to computer for a separate backup. Use Open editable copy from computer to continue from that file. A viewable download is useful for reading; keep the editable copy for future changes.

Writing and artwork for publication

On the canvas, Artists & Writers: Submit for Publication sends writing to the Editor and artwork to the Curator. The work stays private while awaiting approval. If you are in My Vault, choose Continue Working first to return to the canvas and submit.

The Editor reviews writing for publication under your name or pseudonym in the appropriate Library section. The Curator considers artwork for the Gallery. Either may return a piece with a note for reworking. Appointed Editors and Curators use Open review desk in YDS to view submissions and approve or return them.

Other YDS destinations cover event notices, Reading Room information and lessons or guides on the corresponding learning shelves. Letters to the Panel are reviewed by the appropriate Mews or Court Secretary.

One screen or a larger workspace

Use one screen, or choose Tools & Guide then Move all controls to a separate window. On a suitable laptop or PC, keep tools on the device and the canvas on a second monitor. Use Full screen canvas, follow any click prompt and press Esc to exit. Return tools to canvas restores the controls. Extended-display support on iPads varies by model.

Image size and printing

The size indicator warns at 20 MB without stopping you. Large images can slow editing and saving; keep original photographs separately if you use smaller working copies. Print artwork and editable or viewable downloads are available now.

Planned improvements include a dedicated PDF export for posters, artwork and albums, a choice of print size and checks for images that may print poorly. Professional print export and shared image storage are not yet available.